



Delaware County Council Meeting January 26th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1FoE8VTE6hw
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: January 2021 (Exact date not explicitly stated in the transcript opening, though reference is made to the January 4th meeting minutes)

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order shortly after 9:00 AM, opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Tony, and noted the public comment email address: county council dist@co.delaware.in.us.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Webb, Mr. Alexander, Mr. Hughes, Ms. Patterson, Ms. Smith.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Clearly identified as presiding over the meeting (managing roll calls, motions, and agenda items).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Tony.

- **Approval of Agenda:** Approved via roll call (motion by Jessica, second by Brian).
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - [00:39:35](#) Approval of the January 4th meeting minutes.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call (motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Ballard).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:02:06](#) Presentation: Proposed Circuit 6 Court

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric Hoffman (Delaware County Prosecutor) and Judge Voorhees (Circuit Court Judge).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - The prosecutor and judges presented the ongoing operational and fiscal needs for establishing a new Circuit 6 Court.
 - Discussion centered on eliminating the "redo" trials required by Muncie City Court (a court of no record where misdemeanors, domestic violence cases, DUIs, and handguns are tried, leading to repeat trials in circuit court if appealed or retried).
 - Addressed logistics regarding inmate transport from the new Wilson School building back to downtown city court.
 - Reviewed updated fiscal spreadsheet estimates showing a worst-case county overhead cost reduced to approximately \$163,218 annually (factoring in revenue offsets, adjustments to public defender and clerk staffing, probation user fee transfers, and necessary prosecutor/bailiff additions).
 - Council members expressed fiscal caution due to anticipated state-wide budget shortfalls in 2023, while acknowledging the legal and systemic necessity of the court.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal vote taken at this time.
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[00:40:10](#) Financial Transfers & Line Item Reclassifications

- **Adult Probation Reclassification:** Reclassification of a vacant probation administrative support position into an officer supervision role (Line A140 / A175 adjustment).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson and Jeff Hansen (Chief Probation Officer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reclassifying a vacant administrative line item into an officer position to handle transfer cases with no change to salary or total budget. Approved by HR (Pam).

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Ballard).
- **Public Defender Office Transfers:** Reclassification/transfer for two replacement public defenders following resignations (Lines A175 to A170 / B174).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey (Office Administrator).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Replacing two public defenders who resigned on December 31st. Board approved. No creation of new overhead.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Chambers, Second by Ms. Piper).
- **Jail Staffing Transfers:** Lieutenant and corporal position adjustments (Lines C103/E108).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy Marvin (Office Manager) / Sheriff Tony Skinner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filling the lieutenant position while holding corporal positions vacant temporarily pending testing and the facility move.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Ballard).
- **Statewide 911 / Communications Transfers:** Supervisor and dispatcher slot adjustments (Lines C106 / B106).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Paul (Communications Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjusting staffing lines following a full-time staffer moving to part-time and a supervisor stepping down. Addressed severe hiring and retention challenges in public safety dispatching (competing with \$15-\$16/hour retail/service wages, 24/7 shift work burnouts, drug/background hurdles).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Webb).
- **J-CAT Project Transfer:** Moving money from FICA to health insurance (Lines 171 to 173).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocating grant funds now that final grant allocations are settled.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Mr. Quakenbush, Second by Mr. Ballard).
- **Justice Center Communications Transfer:** Communication tech slot adjustment (Lines C117 to D117).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Communications Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments resulting from internal staff step-downs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Chambers, Second by Ms. Lasseter).
- **Jail Correctional Officer Transfer:** Correction officer slot adjustment (Lines C119 to D119).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Tony Skinner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Standard hiring and replacement slot adjustment.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Ballard).
 - **County Council Transfer:** Council member line adjustment (Lines A103 to B103).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine transfer.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call with Mr. Webb abstaining (Motion by Jessica, Second by Ms. Piper/Mr. Quakenbush).
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01:17:58 Additional Appropriations (Grants & Cash Funds)

- **Clerk's Record Perpetuation Fund:** Deputy clerk and benefit appropriations (\$34,770 total).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Ballard).
- **** CASA, J-CAT, and VOCA Grants:**** Grant fund appropriations.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Standard annual grant appropriations to cover operations until reimbursements arrive. Brief discussion regarding a minor discrepancy in VOCA grant anticipated revenue numbers, left at discretion since it is a reimbursable grant.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Mr. Ballard, Second by Ms. Lasseter).
- **Family Recovery Court Grant:** Supplies and training appropriations (\$20,560.69 total).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Ballard).
- **Problem Solving Court Grant:** Supplies/incentives and training appropriations (\$9,500 total).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Ms. Lasseter).
- **Juvenile Probation Fund:** Probation officer salary adjustments (\$37,469 total).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Lasseter, Second by Ms. Piper).
- **COVID-19 GIS Grant:** Contractual services and equipment (\$4,000 total).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Ballard).
- **Unsafe Building Fund:** Recording fees and building cleanup appropriations (\$21,100 total).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Funded through penalty fees on blighted properties; building commissioner Tom Fouch partnering with the health department.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Ballard).
- **GIS Map Fund:** Computer support, professional services, travel, printing, schooling, and equipment (\$274,214 total).

- **Deliberation Summary:** Covers Beacon website hosting, spring aerial photography (2-year cycle), and pavement asset inventory projects (Transmap) supporting community crossing grants.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Ballard).
 - **Comprehensive Plan Fund:** Professional services, travel, printing, dues, schooling, and public meetings (\$329,500 total).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Funded via INDOT transportation planning contract; covers new 20-year comprehensive plan development and strategic investment plan.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Quakenbush).
 - **Supplemental Public Defender Office Furniture/Equipment:** Furniture and equipment appropriations (\$11,500 total, 40% state reimbursable).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Furnishing newly acquired expanded office space and attorney workrooms at the new facility.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Webb).
 - **Sex and Violent Offender (SVO) Fund, DUI Grant Fund, and Misdemeanant Fund:** Sheriff department fund appropriations.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Covers SVO management, DUI/Operation Pulovert overtime reimbursement, and jail equipment/supplies (specifically targeting blind spot cameras at the new jail).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Mr. Ballard, Second by Ms. Piper).
 - **Omnibus Approval:** Motion to approve financial transfers, amend salary ordinance with reductions, and amend hiring freeze ordinance 2020-015.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Ballard).
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01:44:07 Committee Reports & Appointments

- **Board of Appeals Appointment:** Appointment of Carrie Wiggerly to the Board of Appeals (brought forward by Assessor James Carmichael).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Ms. Lasseter).
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01:45:07 Other New Business

- **2021 Encumbrances:** Routine annual approval of prior year encumbrances.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (Motion by Ms. Piper, Second by Mr. Ballard).
 - **Sheriff Department Annual Report:** Sheriff Tony Skinner presented updates on:
 - Pension fund performance (gained 13.85% in the stock market; Baird management fees at ~0.5%).
 - Inmate meal costs (270,000+ meals served in 2020; average cost \$1.45 per meal).
 - Jail staffing analysis (comparing RQAW staffing studies and jail populations).
 - Inmate population trends and commissary fund expenditures.
 - **State Death Certificate Software Issue:** Councilman addressed systemic state software and technological failures affecting funeral directors, coroners, and local health departments regarding death certificates and cremations.
 - **Meeting Date Change:** Discussion regarding moving the March meeting date to March 18th due to spring break scheduling conflicts.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call (Motion by Mr. Ballard, Second by Ms. Piper).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:06:19 Email Correspondence (Read into record by staff/officials due to distribution list technical issues):**
 - **Cameron Grubbs:** Submitted an email expressing serious concerns regarding Councilman Ryan Webb's conduct, public statements, social media posts, handling of mask mandates, and personal attacks. The email urged the council to issue a statement of censure or urge him to step down.
 - **Councilman Ryan Webb:** Addressed the email directly, pushing back against what he termed a coordinated political vendetta, noting that his family had received violent threats, defending his elected mandate, and stating he will not resign.
 - **Andrew Popp:** Submitted an email asking about potential county liability if correctional staff are injured given reports that the new jail will be understaffed. Sheriff Skinner and council members briefly addressed staffing ratios and facility capacities.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Announcements:** 911 Advisory Board meeting scheduled for 4:00 PM virtually; March meeting rescheduled to March 18th.
 - **Adjournment:** Official meeting adjourned following a motion by Ms. Piper and second by Mr. Ballard, approved by unanimous roll call vote.
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